

A Survey Report on Chinese Students' Choice of Majors

Introduction

Choosing a college major is one of the most significant decisions in a young person's life. For many Chinese students, this process is filled with hesitation, uncertainty, and external pressure. To understand how students navigate this important choice, I conducted a survey among my classmates.

Survey Method

I interviewed five classmates from different backgrounds and asked them to respond to a list of statements about their major selection experience. The statements covered various aspects, including the time spent choosing, parental influence, confusion between science and liberal arts, seeking advice, regret, and future concerns. After collecting their responses, I identified the three most commonly agreed statements.

Key Findings

The survey revealed that the following three statements received the most agreement:

1. "It took me a long time to choose a major that I was really interested in." All five interviewees agreed with this statement. They reported spending months, or even years, struggling to identify their true interests. Many said they initially chose a major based on popularity or job prospects, only to realize later that they had little genuine passion for it.

2. "My parents put me under much pressure when I wanted to choose the major I like." Four out of five students agreed with this. They described conflicts with their parents, who often encouraged them to choose "practical" majors like engineering, medicine, or business, rather than following their personal interests in arts, literature, or social sciences. One student shared that her parents refused to support her choice of studying psychology, insisting she

switch to accounting.

3. "I hesitated about whether to choose a science major or liberal arts major." Three interviewees selected this statement. They expressed confusion about which path would lead to better career opportunities. Some felt that science majors were more respected and offered higher salaries, while others were drawn to the creativity and flexibility of liberal arts but worried about job security.

Analysis and Opinions

These findings reveal several important issues in the Chinese education system and family dynamics. First, the prolonged hesitation suggests that high school students lack sufficient career guidance and self-awareness. Without proper counseling, they struggle to make informed decisions about their futures. Second, parental pressure reflects a cultural emphasis on practical outcomes over personal fulfillment. While parents' intentions are good, this approach can lead to dissatisfaction and regret later in life. Third, the science vs. liberal arts dilemma highlights the rigid tracking system in Chinese education, which forces students to make irreversible choices at a young age.

Suggestions

Based on the survey results, I offer the following suggestions. For high school students, I recommend taking career assessment tests and seeking guidance from counselors to better understand your interests and strengths before choosing a major. For parents, I suggest being more open to your children's choices and recognizing that passion often leads to better long-term success than following a practical path. For universities, I recommend offering more flexible policies that allow students to change majors without significant delays in graduation. Finally, for students who are already in college but feel uncertain about their major, remember that many skills are transferable, and your major does not define your entire career.

Conclusion

The process of choosing a major is undoubtedly challenging for Chinese students, shaped by personal uncertainty, parental expectations, and societal pressures. However, by providing better career guidance, fostering open communication

between parents and children, and creating more flexible educational pathways, we can help students make choices that align with their true interests and lead to fulfilling lives.